



The new normal.' Key industry stalwarts who participated in the panel discussion included Rahul Tongia, scholar, researcher and a fellow at Brookings India; Satish Jamadagni, VP, NPE, Reliance Jio; Neelesh Mantri, GM – innovations, SB Energy (SoftBank Group); Amith Singhee, senior technical manager, IBM Research; Snigdha Singh, executive director – technology division, Morgan Stanley; and Martin Woolley, technical programme manager for the EMEA region, Bluetooth SIG. The session was moderated by Narang N. Kishor, founder, Namix Technolabs Pvt Ltd.

Karnataka Biotechnology & Information Technology Services (KBITS), which was set up by the Karnataka state government, is upbeat about the electronics industry in the state, and it has some concrete plans to boost this sector with major investments.

Addressing the audience at the third edition of India Electronics Week, Uma Rani, assistant GM, KBITS said that, "KBITS is looking to stimulate the growth of 2000 technology-based startups including 6000 product startups by 2020, in Karnataka."

IoT, the next big thing

Day 2 of the conference started with the Internet of Things (IoT) theme. Industry leaders discussed the security aspects of the IoT—whether current concerns were based on myth or the scary truth. Leaders from AT&T, Wipro and LDRA highlighted how IoT has become a significant part of one's life, and that consumers should be cautious when using such connected devices.

Tulika Pandey, scientist (F category), under MeitY, government of India, highlighted an important aspect of IoT. She said, "In the future, we may choose robots as our companions rather than pets or human beings because we can control the behaviour of devices."

Some industry leaders pointed out that, currently, IoT is a scary threat because it not only leads to financial or data losses but it's also a threat to our safety and life.

The conference also had different sessions covering topics such as 'How can systems integrators profit from IoT', IoT and data analytics, etc.

The attendees spent their days at the informative workshops running simultaneously at IEW. Some of the key workshops were 'Make your first IoT product', 'How to obtain seamless device connectivity with IoTivity and Zephyr' and 'Make real IoT products that sell.'

Startup gyan

Startups in the electronics domain are taking baby steps to consolidate their business in an area where established companies control the market. Industry veterans shared personal anecdotes and mantras with the startups, along with their do's and don'ts, in order to achieve success.

Sanjeev Keskar, MD, Arrow Electronics shared that one has to create differentiation in order to add a value proposition to the product. For any product idea, one has to target its potential customers first and engage with them. He added, "There is no point creating a white elephant without any takers."

P.V.G. Menon, president and CEO, Vann Consulting highlighted the need for a value proposition. The veteran industry leader pointed out that the Indian startups and electronics manufacturers have no room to make inferior products because of the tough competition from the world leaders.

ELCINA also organised its seminar on 'Technology developed for electronics sector- MeitY initiatives.'

Initiating the dialogue, Subhash Goyal, past president of ELCINA said, "We are here to support emerging trends in electronics, and this is the second birth for the electronics industry with initiatives like Make in India."

Sharing what has been done so far by MeitY and how the Indian government is upbeat about the electronics sector, Dr Sandip Chatterjee, director, MeitY said, "We have schemes to encourage the filing of patents, for R&D deployments, and for design and application development. India is a space for opportunity."

Exhibitors under various categories participated in IEW 2018. Some of the key categories were design and development services, test and measurement equipment, platforms for the development of IoT solutions, IoT solutions for industrial applications, generic IoT solutions, components, LED lighting, education, training and consultancy services, PCBs, IoT in retail, power electronics, 3D printers and related services, chemicals and consumables for electronics manufacturing, electronics manufacturing equipment, EDA tools and electronics manufacturing service providers.

Some of the major supporters and partners of IEW were Qualcomm, Mouser Electronics, Saison, the government of Karnataka and Intel.

IEW has emerged as an excellent platform for business and networking. It can also be termed as the New Age Electronics Show. The five co-located events offered a cross-pollination of business opportunities and included some of India's largest technology conferences, powered by industry thought-leaders. IEW 2018 kept its promise to grow bigger and better with every passing year. Around 200 exhibitors, thousands of attendees, industry leaders and key decision makers made their presence felt at the third edition of IEW.

IEW will be back next year with more insights, and a different agenda for the fourth edition of this event—IEW 2019, which will again be held in Bengaluru from 26th to 28th February, 2019. **EFY**